

Peas (Sweet)

CULTIVARS

- Super sugar snap: widely available, earlier, resistant to powdery mildew
- Sugar snap: productive, delicious, resistant to some diseases, but not mildew

A mixture of the two varieties is ideal as you can benefit from the qualities each one has to offer: the earliness of the Super sugar and the abundance and taste of the Sugar.

INTENSIVE SPACING

- *2 rows (18"- 45 cm) per bed spaced every 0,5" (13 mm) along the row.
- Earthway seeder: Jumbo peas plate, 2-3 passages. Seed into 1" (2.5cm) deep furrow

*When planting more than one bed side by side, adjust density to 1 row per bed (leaving enough room between the beds for comfortable harvesting).

FERTILIZATION

- Like beans, peas will do best in beds amended with compost, fresh or aged. Rule of thumb is to spread 1 inch (5 cm) in the middle of the bed.
- When planting in beds where compost was applied in the previous crops, we only supplement with a mixture of alfalfa meal (2-0-2) and pelleted chicken manure (5-3-2). Add this extra fertility boost at first cultivation 3-4 weeks after the direct sown date.
- Inoculants can increase yields by promoting a rhizobium-pea symbiosis that facilitates nitrogen fixation. If nitrogen-fixing nodules are not found on most legumes grown in a specific planting area (ie new beds), inoculants are added to the seeds when sowing. Follow the manufacturer's instructions.

IRRIGATION

Irrigation Type

- Drip tape only (2 per bed)
- No sprinkler to keep foliage and pods dry and thus prevent diseases

Irrigation Management

- Root depth: Shallow (6"-24")
- General: Can drink lots of water because they are fast growing. Vulnerable to disease with overhead water.

IMPLANTATION

Sweet peas are a very popular crop with customers, especially in early spring when they're taste is incredible. Like beans, peas have low productivity rates being time-consuming to harvest. To grow this crop profitably, we ensure the plants are properly fertilized, have the right amount of Rhizobium, are rigorously staked and trellised, and are harvested often.

For a continuous supply, we seed new beds every 4 weeks

EQUIPMENT

- Rotary harrow
- 30" bed prep rake
- **Direct Seeding:** Hands or Earthway seeder (+ jumbo bean plate). 2 tubes for the rake, scale, notepad and your seeds
- **Transplanting:** Popping tray

ITINERARY

- Remove tarp and clean out large debris. Use the rake if needed.*
- If adding compost, uniformly apply it in the center and pass with the rotary harrow at a depth of 1.5" (4 cm). Use the rake to remove debris if needed. Otherwise, the bed is ready to be seeded.

- Mark your 2 rows with the bed prep rake, pressing hard to create a furrow at least 1" deep (5cm) and seed with your hands by rolling the seeds close to another on the furrow.
- Write down the total amount of seed dropped onto the first bed and comparing with the target. Adjust calibration if required.
- If using the Earthway, 2 or 3 passes will be required to obtain the desired density.
- Install irrigation and water until the soil is deeply moistened. Keep moist for the next 7-10 days until all seeds have germinated. Once the seeds have germinated, favour drip irrigation over overhead if the plants need watering.
- Start some extra seedlings in the greenhouse to fill in the holes on the beds. Ideally, These should be started in the week prior to when the direct seeding is done.
- Minimum soil temperature is 15°C (20°C is optimal). If seeded in soil that is too cold, cover seedbed with clear plastic one week prior to seeding date
-

*If the previous crop is too well established, or if the bed is too messy, mow the previous crop as low as possible and cover it with soil by raising the bed about an inch using the rotary plow.

WEEDING

- +/- 18 days after peas have been sowed the crops are cultivated using a stirrup or wheel hoe and amended bed with blood or alfalfa meal. Hoeing will take care of the weeds, break the crust and mix your amendments in the soil.
- When the peas reach 6" (15cm) in size, cover the beds with a +/-4" of straw mulch (10 cm). This will keep the crop clean of weeds since it will now be trellised.

TRELLISSING

- Once the plants have been fertilized and the straw laid down, install a T-bar at the beginning of each row (in line with the crop), and then another T-bar every 15' (4,5M) until the end of the row. Use a stake driver to make the work easier.

- Once the plants have reached 6" (15cm), install the first line of bailing twine, crossing it from the inside-out of each stake.
- From now on, repeat with new lines of cord at every 5" of growth to secure the plants (once a week).
- The success of this simple trellising strategy will depend never allowing the plants to outgrow the new string, falling over in an irrecoverable way.

PLANT PROTECTION

- As they reach the end of their life, peas are often attacked by powdery mildew or other fungal diseases. If such diseases manifest before the last 2 weeks of harvest, apply sulfur-based treatments.

HARVEST

- Peas are harvested in the fields in a kneeling position using a solid-bottom bins (to prevent dirtying the peas)
- Harvesting peas is a simple, repetitive task that can be time-consuming. It is therefore imperative to work quickly to optimize the profitability of the crop.
- To harvest with one hand (so to use both simultaneously), hold the peas between the index finger, middle finger and ring finger, and use the thumb to break the bean off the peduncle.
- Make sure to gather at least 4 -5 peas in each hand before putting them in the bin (to keep long hand motions to a minimum).
- Start by harvesting the peas at the bottom of the plant, working upwards to follow the maturation process .
- Harvest only the one that have reached the diameter of a baby finger (for maximum sweetness). They should be clean and free from any mold or rotting.
- Harvest every second day to pick them at the right time & Inasmuch as possible, harvest when it isn't raining (dry produce keeps better).

CONDITIONING

- It is best not to let the peas get wet (to prevent rust) and therefore they should not be washed
- If the peas do get damp, open the bins and let them dry in the cold room for a couple of hours (max 4 hours as they may decrease in quality).

STORING

- Peas are stored in airtight bins and kept cold room kept at 35 °F (2 °C) and should not stay longer than 4 days before being sold.